

Leaves of the
plane tree



Tradescant
father and son

GOING WEST
John Tradescant and his son, also named John, were English plantsmen. Tradescant the Elder collected in Russia, and Tradescant the Younger collected in the Americas. The younger Tradescant imported trees into Europe. These included the tulip tree and the western plane.

FIT FOR ROYALTY
Plant collecting is an ancient pursuit. This Egyptian mural shows the earliest recorded expedition, which took place in 1495 BCE. Collectors brought back frankincense trees for Queen Hatshepsut from the Horn of Africa.



Tradescantia—a border plant named after John Tradescant the Elder

Beautifully preserved
botanical reference books



THE EMPRESS COLLECTOR
Empress Josephine, the wife of Napoleon, created a unique garden at her house at Malmaison, with roses brought from all around the world. At the time, France was at war with Britain, but ships carrying the imperial roses were allowed safe passage.